Decide Now Who Keeps the Care Plan Current and What Would Trigger a Review

Four prompts to name the changes that should send your family back to the plan, set a review rhythm that fits real life, pick a document owner and a backup, and list the review requirements you'll need to confirm with an actual provider.

Where you are

You've got a first version of a care plan for the person you're caring for, and that already feels like an achievement. Nothing is pressing. But plans go stale, and nobody has said who will keep this one current or what would make you look at it again.

This guide gives you four ChatGPT prompts to organize what you already know and to see what you don't know yet. It is preparation, not an assessment. Use only information you have permission to share, with names removed. The AI organizes and drafts; it does not diagnose, assess safety, or decide. Bring clinical questions to a clinician, and call emergency services for an emergency.

What you'll have at the end

You can say which changes would bring your family back to the plan, when you'll look at it anyway, who holds the current version, and which review questions are still waiting for a provider.

A one-page review readiness sheet: What would trigger a review, Our family review dates, Who keeps the current version, and Provider review requirements to confirm.

Before you start

- The current plan, with its date, in whatever form it exists.
- A sense of the family's calendar: who is reliably around, who travels, who is already stretched.
- Anything a provider or clinician has already said about reviews, if anything. Having nothing on that last point is fine; this guide helps you ask.

PROMPT 1

Name the changes that would send you back to the plan

WHY THIS MATTERS

A plan doesn't announce when it has gone out of date. The family has to decide in advance what kinds of change would mean 'look at this again,' and write them in words two relatives would both recognize.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The current plan or its main points, with the date it was written.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is the current care plan for the person I'm caring for, written on [DATE]:
>
> [PASTE THE PLAN OR ITS MAIN POINTS]
>
> Go through it and, for each section, list the kinds of change that would make that section out of date: changes in what the person can do, in what they prefer, in who is available to help, in where they live, or in money and paperwork. Write them as plain observable statements a family member could recognize, such as 'needs help with something they used to do alone.' Group them under FAMILY CAN NOTICE and WOULD NEED A PROFESSIONAL TO ASSESS. Do not predict which changes are likely, how soon, or what they would mean for care.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

Triggers concrete enough that two relatives would agree one had happened.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Cross out any trigger you couldn't actually observe and rewrite it until you could.

PROMPT 2

Set a family review rhythm that fits real life

WHY THIS MATTERS

Families either never review the plan or invent a strict schedule they've heard somewhere and then feel guilty about missing. A modest rhythm you'll actually keep beats a rule you'll abandon by summer.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

A few lines on who is involved, where they live, how often you're already in touch, and what else is on everyone's plate.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is my family's situation: who is involved in caring for [THE PERSON], where everyone lives, how often we're already in touch, and what else is on our plates:
>
> [PASTE YOUR NOTES]
>
> Suggest two or three options for how often the family could realistically sit down and look at the care plan together, from a quick call to a longer review, with the trade-offs of each in one line. Tie each option to the triggers we already have so a review also happens when something changes,

> not only on the calendar. Make clear these are family check-ins we're choosing, not a required schedule, and do not state any legal or provider review rule.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

An option that would survive a busy year. Ambitious schedules get skipped once and then abandoned.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Pick one option, put the first date in everyone's calendar, and keep that first review short.

PROMPT 3

Pick who holds the current version, and a backup

WHY THIS MATTERS

If nobody owns the document, everybody has a slightly different copy. If one person owns it with no backup, the plan disappears the week they get sick. Both are easy to prevent now.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

Names of the people involved, with a note on each one's reliability with paperwork, comfort with technology, and how much they already carry.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> These are the relatives and friends involved in planning care for the person I'm caring for, with a note on each one's reliability with paperwork, comfort with technology, and how much they already carry:
>
> [PASTE NAMES AND NOTES]
>
> List the jobs involved in keeping one plan current: holding the master copy, dating and numbering each version, telling everyone when it changes, keeping the old versions, and reminding the family of review dates. For each job, suggest who could do it and who could be the backup, with one line on why. Then propose a simple way to name versions, such as a date in the file name. Give us options to discuss rather than a decision.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A backup for the person who always ends up doing everything.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

Ask the two people named most whether they're willing, before anyone assumes.

PROMPT 4

Write the sheet and the questions for a future provider

WHY THIS MATTERS

Some review dates will come from a provider you haven't chosen yet, and you can't know them now. You can leave labeled blanks so the family never mistakes a guess for a requirement.

WHAT YOU'LL NEED

The trigger list, the review option you chose, and the ownership table.

COPY THIS PROMPT

> Here is our work so far on keeping the care plan current for the person I'm caring for:
>
> [PASTE PROMPTS 1 TO 3]
>
> Write one page with four headings: WHAT WOULD TRIGGER A REVIEW, OUR FAMILY REVIEW DATES, WHO KEEPS THE CURRENT VERSION, and PROVIDER REVIEW REQUIREMENTS TO CONFIRM. Under the last heading, write the questions we'd ask any future agency, residence, or clinician about how often they review a care plan, who takes part, how a family requests one, and how changes get communicated. Leave the answers blank and mark each one UNCONFIRMED. Add 'Version 1, [DATE]' at the top. Do not fill in any requirement you haven't been told.

WHAT TO LOOK FOR

A page whose last section is all questions. That's correct; those answers can only come from a provider.

WHAT TO DO NEXT

File it as Version 1 and tell the person who holds the master copy where it is.

Make version one worth keeping current

A plan can only be kept current if version one is clear. The care interview organizes the situation of the person you're caring for into a Family Care Profile, a dated starting file that your review triggers and ownership decisions can refer back to.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›